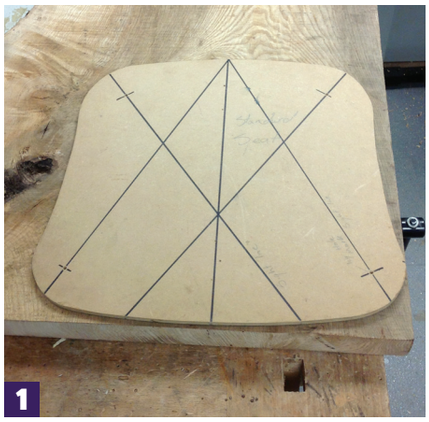
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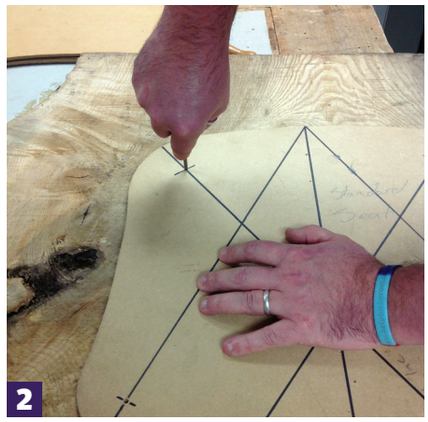
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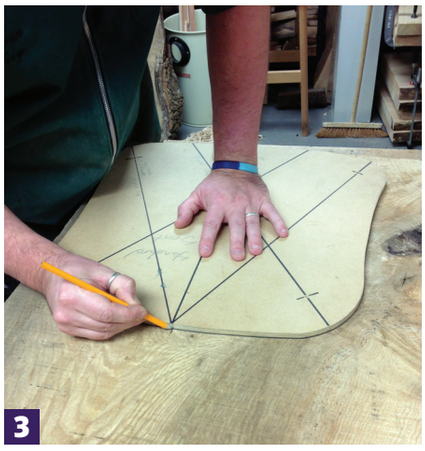
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Marking, cutting out and shaping the seat

1 Use a template to mark out the seat that measures 475 x 445mm. Position the template to make the most out of the grain: I position the template to have the grain running from front-to-back as opposed to side-to-side, which I feel looks a bit better but this is not compulsory. You can clearly see the sight lines drawn on the template; these will be used to mark the seat blank

2 After you've marked the seat out with pencil and without moving the template, use a bradawl to dot the position of the legs. This will be our centre point when drilling for the legs later on. All the instructions and measurements for the template can be seen in the technical drawings (*see opposite*)

3 Again using the template, mark the positions of the site lines with pencil onto your blank. Now, using a rule and pencil, join all of your markings together to replicate the site lines from your template

4 Once your blank has all the sight lines and the leg positions marked onto it, start to cut the blank out. Here I'm using a bandsaw, but a handheld jigsaw will work equally well. Try and keep as close to the pencil line as possible. This will save a lot of elbow grease later when using hand tools to tidy up the blank

5 Now we are going to use the second template to add a second line over the blank. This line will be used when shaping the scoop in the top of the seat

6 Draw a heavy line to use as your stop line. It is important to be able to clearly see this line when using the power tools. Here is the fully prepped seat blank with its sight lines and second template markings on

7 Now for the fun part: shaping the seat! Use an angle grinder with a turbo plane blade. This gives a really quick way of roughing out the seat ready for hand tools. However, great care must be taken when using these power tools and carving heads, so if you feel uncomfortable in using them stick to hand tools

8 At this point the seat should be roughed out and ready for finishing hand tools and fine tuning. I personally test all my seats while shaping by putting the seat blank on a stool and sitting on it. I do this until the seat shape fits me perfectly

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